

The rise of fascism

In 1919, Italian leader Benito Mussolini named his political party *Fasci Italiani di Combattimento*, which later came to power as the National Fascist Party. A fascist government has a strong leader, often a dictator, who has total control of society and the economy and suppresses all political opposition. By the end of the 1930s, fascist governments took power across southern and Eastern Europe, such as in Portugal, Greece, and Croatia. Small-scale fascist movements also arose in Britain, Ireland, the US, and other democratic countries. In Germany, fascism flourished under the name of Nazism, but, unlike Italy, one of its main features was extreme anti-Semitism (hatred of Jewish people).

◀ ADOLF HITLER

In 1919, Austrian-born Adolf Hitler joined the small right-wing German Worker's Party, which later became the National Socialist German Workers'—or Nazi—Party under his leadership. The Nazis took power in Germany in 1933, staging huge rallies, such as this one at Nuremberg, to gain support. Hitler led Germany into World War II in 1939, and died by suicide when Germany was defeated in 1945.



▲ BENITO MUSSOLINI

In 1921, Benito Mussolini founded the National Fascist Party to campaign for a fascist state in Italy. After staging a march on Rome in October 1922 in order to seize power, he was appointed prime minister of Italy by the king. Mussolini governed Italy until he was deposed in 1943.

